

Word family: **contrast / contrasts / contrasted / contrasting / contrastive / contrastingly**

Base word: contrast

Part of speech: **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

contrast (n.) — 對比；反差；差異

contrast (v.) — 對比；比較差異

contrasting (adj.) — 形成對比的；截然不同的

contrastive (adj.) — 對比性的，常見於語言學等較正式語境

contrastingly (adv., uncommon) — 對比地

Useful expressions / extensions:

in contrast

by contrast

in contrast to / with

contrast A with B

contrast sharply with

a sharp / striking contrast

a marked contrast

create / provide a contrast

contrast in colour

high contrast

contrast ratio

contrasting colours

contrastive analysis

Meaning in this passage

> This photo album, **by contrast**, felt far more thoughtful and one of a kind.

Here, **by contrast** means:

when compared with the previous gifts, the photo album was noticeably different — 相比之下；相反地

The speaker compares the handmade album with earlier gifts such as books, chocolates, wallets, and gift cards.

中文翻譯：

相比之下，這本相簿明顯更有心思，而且是獨一無二的。

So here:

****by contrast = 與前面提到的事物比較之下，呈現出明顯不同****

1. ****contrast (對比；反差) — 對比；差異****

This is the core noun sense.

Practice 1

> There is a clear ****contrast**** between the two gifts.

兩份禮物之間有很明顯的****對比****。

Practice 2

> The ****contrast**** between old and new is striking.

新舊之間的****反差****很明顯。

Practice 3

> The essay examines the ****contrast**** between city and country life.

這篇文章分析城市與鄉村生活之間的****差異與對比****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contrast = a noticeable difference between two or more things when they are compared****

中文：

****兩個或以上事物比較時所顯示出的明顯差異****

2. ****by contrast — 相比之下；相反地****

This is the exact expression used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> This photo album, ****by contrast****, felt far more thoughtful.

****相比之下****，這本相簿顯得有心思得多。

Practice 2

> The first plan was expensive. ****By contrast****, the second was quite affordable.

第一個方案很昂貴。****相比之下****，第二個相當便宜。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****by contrast = used to introduce something noticeably different from what has just been mentioned****

中文：

****用來引出與前面所述情況明顯不同的事物****

3. ****in contrast — 相比之下；形成對照的是****

Practice 1

> His brother is very outgoing. ****In contrast****, he is quiet.

他哥哥很外向。****相比之下****，他很安靜。

Practice 2

> The old building is dark; ****in contrast****, the new one is bright.

舊建築很暗；****相比之下****，新建築很明亮。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in contrast = used to emphasize a difference between things****

4. ****in contrast to / with — 與.....相比；與.....形成對比****

Practice 1

> ****In contrast to**** her previous gifts, the album was highly personal.

****與她之前的禮物相比****，這本相簿非常有個人感情。

Practice 2

> His calm manner stood **in contrast with** the tense atmosphere.

他冷靜的態度與緊張的氣氛**形成鮮明對比**。

MCQ-ready definition:

in contrast to/with X = when compared with X, showing a noticeable difference

5. **contrast A with B — 把 A 與 B 作對比**

Verb sense.

Practice 1

> The essay **contrasts city life with country life**.

這篇文章把城市生活和鄉村生活**作對比**。

Practice 2

> The speaker **contrasted handmade gifts with shop-bought ones**.

講者把手工禮物和商店購買的禮物**作比較對照**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contrast A with B = compare A and B in order to show their differences

中文：

把 A 和 B 放在一起比較，以突出兩者差異

6. **contrast with something — 與.....形成對比**

Practice 1

> Her cheerful voice **contrasted with** his serious expression.

她開朗的聲音和他嚴肅的表情**形成對比**。

Practice 2

> The modern furniture **contrasts with** the old walls.

現代家具和舊牆身**形成反差**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contrast with X = be noticeably different from X****

7. ****contrast sharply with — 與.....形成鮮明對比****

Practice 1

> The quiet room ****contrasted sharply with**** the noisy street outside.

安靜的房間和外面嘈雜的街道****形成鮮明對比****。

Practice 2

> His generous behaviour ****contrasted sharply with**** her selfishness.

他的慷慨行為和她的自私****形成強烈對比****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contrast sharply with = differ from something in a very obvious or strong way****

8. ****a sharp / striking contrast — 強烈 / 鮮明對比****

Practice 1

> There was a ****sharp contrast**** between the two designs.

兩個設計之間有****強烈對比****。

Practice 2

> Her calm reaction was a ****striking contrast**** to everyone else's panic.

她冷靜的反應與其他人的慌張形成了****鮮明對比****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sharp/striking contrast = a very noticeable difference****

9. **a marked contrast** — 明顯對比

Slightly more formal.

Practice 1

> His new attitude is a **marked contrast** to his old one.

他現在的態度和以前相比有**明顯差異**。

Practice 2

> The second half showed a **marked contrast** in performance.

下半場的表現出現了**明顯反差**。

MCQ-ready definition:

marked contrast = a clearly noticeable difference

10. **create / provide a contrast** — 形成對比

Practice 1

> The dark frame **creates a contrast** with the white wall.

深色畫框和白牆**形成對比**。

Practice 2

> The quiet music **provides a contrast** to the dramatic scene.

安靜的音樂和戲劇性的場景**形成反差**。

MCQ-ready definition:

create/provide a contrast = make a difference between things noticeable

11. **contrast in colour / texture / style** — 顏色 / 質感 / 風格上的對比

Practice 1

> I like the **contrast in colour** between the blue and orange.

我喜歡藍色和橙色之間的**色彩對比**。

Practice 2

> The room uses a **contrast of textures**.

房間利用不同材質製造**質感反差**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contrast in X = noticeable difference in a particular feature such as colour, shape, texture, or style****

12. **high contrast — 高對比度**

A visual/photographic sense.

Practice 1

> The photograph has very **high contrast**.

這張照片的**對比度很高**。

Practice 2

> High-contrast text is easier to read.

****高對比度文字**比較容易閱讀。**

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****high contrast = a strong difference between light and dark or between visual elements****

13. **low contrast — 低對比度**

Practice 1

> The image looks soft because it has **low contrast**.

這張圖片因為**對比度低**，所以看起來較柔和。

Practice 2

> Low-contrast text can be difficult to read.

****低對比度文字**可能較難閱讀。**

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****low contrast = only a small visual difference between tones, colours, or elements****

14. ****contrast ratio — 對比度比率****

A technical display/photography term.

Practice 1

> The monitor has a high ****contrast ratio****.

這部顯示器有很高的****對比度比率****。

Practice 2

> A better ****contrast ratio**** can improve image clarity.

較高的****對比度比率****可以提升畫面清晰度。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contrast ratio = the measurable difference between the brightest and darkest parts of a display or image****

15. ****contrasting colours — 對比色；形成反差的顏色****

Practice 1

> She used ****contrasting colours**** in the design.

她在設計中使用了****對比色****。

Practice 2

> The red scarf stood out against the ****contrasting blue coat****.

紅色圍巾和形成反差的藍色外套互相映襯。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contrasting colours = colours that are noticeably different and make each other stand out****

16. **contrasting ideas / styles** — 對立 / 不同的觀點或風格

Practice 1

> The article presents two **contrasting views**.

文章提出兩種**截然不同的觀點**。

Practice 2

> The building combines **contrasting styles**.

這棟建築結合了**形成強烈反差的不同風格**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contrasting = clearly different when compared side by side

17. **contrastive** — 對比性的

A formal/academic adjective.

Practice 1

> The study uses a **contrastive approach**.

這項研究採用**對比式方法**。

Practice 2

> Linguists carried out a **contrastive analysis** of the two languages.

語言學家對兩種語言進行了**對比分析**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contrastive = based on systematically comparing differences between things

18. **contrastive analysis** — 對比分析

Especially common in linguistics and education.

Practice 1

> **Contrastive analysis** can reveal differences between English and Chinese grammar.

對比分析可以顯示英文和中文文法的差異。

Practice 2

> The teacher used **contrastive analysis** to explain the two structures.

老師利用**對比分析**解釋兩種結構。

MCQ-ready definition:

contrastive analysis = systematic comparison designed to identify differences between two systems

Important distinction 1: **contrast vs compare**

compare

looks at similarities and/or differences.

contrast

focuses specifically on differences.

> Compare the two photos.

比較兩張照片，可以看相同或不同之處。

> Contrast the two photos.

比較兩張照片，重點是**找差異**。

This is one of the most important distinctions.

Important distinction 2: **by contrast vs in contrast**

They are very close.

by contrast

often introduces the second side of a comparison.

in contrast

can do the same, and also appears naturally in **in contrast to/with**.

> The old gifts were predictable. **By contrast**, the album was personal.

> **In contrast**, the album was personal.

Both work.

Important distinction 3: **in contrast to vs compared with**

in contrast to

strongly emphasizes difference.

compared with

neutral comparison; may show similarity or difference.

> In contrast to the old gifts, the album was personal.

= 強調反差

> Compared with the old gifts, the album was more personal.

= 一般比較

Important distinction 4: **contrast vs difference**

difference

general fact that things are not the same.

contrast

often emphasizes a visible, striking, or meaningful difference.

> There is a difference in price.

價錢不同。

> There is a striking contrast in style.

風格形成鮮明反差。

Important distinction 5: **contrast vs opposite**

contrast

things differ noticeably.

opposite

things are at opposing ends or directly contrary.

Two things can contrast without being complete opposites.

Important distinction 6: **contrast noun vs verb**

Noun

> a clear **contrast**

明顯對比

Verb

> **contrast** A with B

把 A 和 B 作對比

Learners should watch the grammar.

Important distinction 7: **contrast A with B vs compare A to/with B**

contrast A with B

highlight differences.

compare A with B

examine similarities and differences.

compare A to B

can also mean liken A to B.

So **contrast** is semantically narrower.

Important distinction 8: **by contrast vs on the contrary**

These are often confused.

by contrast

= 相比之下

> My brother is outgoing. By contrast, I'm quiet.

on the contrary

= 恰恰相反；用來否定前一說法

> He isn't lazy. On the contrary, he works extremely hard.

So **on the contrary** usually corrects or rejects an idea, while **by contrast** simply compares.

Important distinction 9: **contrast vs contradiction**

contrast

difference.

contradiction

direct inconsistency or logical conflict.

> Their styles contrast.

他們風格不同。

> Their statements contradict each other.

他們的說法互相矛盾。

Important distinction 10: **high contrast vs bright**

high contrast

large difference between dark/light or visual elements.

bright

high light intensity or vivid appearance.

A picture can be bright but still low-contrast.

Important distinction 11: **contrasting vs contradictory**

contrasting views

very different views.

contradictory statements

statements that cannot both be true in the same sense/context.

So “contrasting” does not automatically mean logical contradiction.

Important distinction 12: **contrastive vs contrasting**

contrasting

describes things that visibly differ.

> contrasting colours

對比色

contrastive

more formal/technical, meaning based on deliberate comparison.

> contrastive analysis

對比分析

Family-extension note

****Contrast**** has three major learner-relevant branches:

1. ****difference between things****

- * a clear contrast
- * sharp contrast
- * marked contrast

2. ****comparison emphasizing difference****

- * contrast A with B
- * in contrast to
- * by contrast

3. ****visual difference****

- * high contrast
- * contrast ratio
- * contrasting colours

And one academic extension:

4. ****contrastive****

- * contrastive analysis
- * contrastive approach

The semantic core stays stable:

****put two or more things side by side so their differences become noticeable****

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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contrast (noun)	對比；反差	noticeable difference
by contrast	相比之下	introduce difference
in contrast	相比之下	emphasize difference
in contrast to/with	與.....相比 / 形成對比	compare differences
contrast A with B	把 A 與 B 對比	compare differences
contrast with X	與 X 形成對比	be noticeably different
contrast sharply with	與.....形成鮮明對比	strong difference
sharp contrast	強烈對比	obvious difference
striking contrast	鮮明反差	very noticeable difference
marked contrast	明顯對比	clear difference
create/provide a contrast	形成對比	make difference visible
contrast in colour/style	色彩 / 風格對比	difference in feature
high contrast	高對比度	strong visual difference
low contrast	低對比度	weak visual difference
contrast ratio	對比度比率	visual measurement
contrasting colours	對比色	visually different colours
contrasting views	截然不同的觀點	differing ideas
contrastive	對比性的	systematic comparison
contrastive analysis	對比分析	compare systems

For your original sentence

> This photo album, ****by contrast****, felt far more thoughtful and one of a kind.

Here:

****by contrast** = 與前面那些普通、穩陣、可預料的禮物相比之下**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> ****相比之下****，這本相簿明顯更有心思，而且是獨一無二的。

The key point is that ****contrast**** focuses on ****difference****, not just general comparison. The speaker is deliberately setting up two sides:

> standard, safe, predictable gifts

> ****vs.****

> personal, thoughtful, one-of-a-kind album.